

Dan Brodtkin

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Citizenship: USA, Canada

Research Syntax; Prosody; Extended Projection; A-Ā Divide; Structure of the PF Branch

Employment **University of Pennsylvania** Philadelphia, Pennsylvania
Postdoctoral Fellow in Syntax September 2025 – Present

Education **University of California, Santa Cruz** Santa Cruz, California
PhD in Linguistics September 2018 – August 2025

Carleton College Northfield, Minnesota
BA in Linguistics; BA in History September 2014 – June 2018

Scholarships Graduate Research Fellowship (National Science Foundation) 2018-2023
Predoctoral Fellowship (University of California, Santa Cruz) 2018-2024
Fulbright Research Fellowship (US Department of State) 2018-2019
Critical Language Enhancement Award (US Department of State) 2018
Critical Language Scholarship (US Department of State) 2017

Journal Publications

Under Revision

Pseudopassives, Pied-Piping, and A-Movement of PPs

Subject Positions, High Absolutives, and Austronesian Voice

Chain Reduction at the Syntax-Prosody Interface

Accepted

The Prosody of Paths

Syntactic Theory and Research

Demonstratives, Reinforcers, and Movement to the Right

Linguistic Inquiry

Accepted

with Revisions

Explaining the Ban on Ergative Anaphors

Glossa

First author; with Justin Royer

2025

The Prosody of the Extended VP

Natural Language and Linguistic Theory

Suppletion in Global Perspective

Linguistic Inquiry

2022

Two Steps to High Absolutive Syntax

The Journal of East Asian Linguistics

Invited

Contributions

In Prep

Voice

The Routledge Handbook of Syntax, Second Edition

with Mitcho Erlewine

To Appear

The Phonology of Indonesian

The International Encyclopedia of Language and Linguistics, Third Edition

2024

Constraining Subcategory-Sensitive Match Constraints

Syntax-Prosody in Optimality Theory: Theory and Analyses

(*Advances in Optimality Theory*)

with Nick van Handel and Ben Eischens

Working Papers

2024

The Ban on Ergative Anaphors

Proceedings of WCCFL 39

with Justin Royer

2022

Perception Verb Complements in Mandarin

Syntax and Semantics at Santa Cruz V

Two Steps to High Absolutive Syntax

MA Thesis; UCSC

2021

Anti-Agreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi

Proceedings of NELS 51

Second-Position Clitics and Prosodic Recursion

Proceedings of AMP 2020

Object Shift and Agent Extraction in Mandarin

Proceedings of AFLA 27

2020

Pseudoclefts and Parameters in the Pacific

Syntax and Semantics at Santa Cruz IV

Invited Talks

2026

Time Travel in the Mandarin TP

Boston Morphology Workshop (EXO-Words IV)

A-Syntax at the Edge

Speaker Series; Georgetown University

2024	The Prosody of Paths Phonological Domains Workshop; UC Berkeley
Around Indonesia (Titles translated) Nov 2023	The Importance of Research on the Languages of West Sulawesi The University of West Sulawesi, Majene Poetic Meter in the Languages of Sulawesi Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta Challenges in Regional Language Pedagogy Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta
Aug 2023	Ellipsis, Minimality, and Movement in Mandar The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta Why Generative Linguistics? The View from a Regional Language The National Institute for Research and Innovation, Makassar; <i>with Jupri Talib</i> Functional Word Lengthening in Mandar: A Generative Perspective Hasanuddin University, Makassar
Aug 2022	Linguistic Theory at the Frontiers of Cross-Cultural Understanding The Language Office of East Java, Surabaya Universal Grammar in West Sulawesi Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta Phonological Displacement in Mandar The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta
2019	Language Death in Indonesia Bina Nusantara University, Jakarta Pseudoclefts and Pied Piping with Inversion in Mandar Summer Linguistics Meet-Up; National University of Singapore Clitic Placement in the Languages of South Sulawesi Kolita 17; The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta Language Death in Indonesia East Asia-Pacific Fulbright Regional Conference; Taipei

Conference Talks

2024

The Linguistic History of Sulawesi

State University of Malang, Malang

The Prosody of Paths

AFLA 31; UMass Amherst

Metrical Structure in Mandar Phonology and Poetry

Kolita 22; The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya, Jakarta

May 28, 2024

with Maria Tamarina Prawati and Jupri Talib

The Prosody of the Extended VP

Annual Meeting of the Linguistics Society of America

January 7, 2024

2023

Pemindahan Kata dalam sebuah bahasa di Sulawesi

(Rightward Movement in a language of Sulawesi)

3rd Annual AIFIS-MSU Conference on Indonesian Studies

with Jupri Talib

2022

Prosodic Greed in Mandar

TripleAFLA; University of Manchester

Apa itu Subyek? Perspektif Dari Sulawesi

(What's a Subject? A Perspective from Sulawesi)

2nd Annual AIFIS-MSU Conference on Indonesian Studies

with Jupri Talib

2021

Philippine Voice and Split Absolutive Syntax

AFLA 28; McGill University

Two Constraints on Ergative Anaphors

AFLA 28; McGill University

with Justin Royer

Wh-Movement in Mandar

95th Meeting of the LSA; San Francisco

2020

Object Shift and Agent Extraction in Mandar

AFLA 27; NUS

Posters

2024

Height and Locality in Mandar $\bar{A}$ -Extraction

AFLA 31; UMass Amherst

2022

Existential Match: Evidence from Mandar

AMP 2022; UCLA

2021	Ergative Anaphors and High Absolutive Syntax WCCFL 39; University of Arizona, Tucson	<i>with Justin Royer</i>
2020	Anti-Agreement is Syntactic: Evidence from South Sulawesi NELS 51; UQAM	
	Second Position and Prosodic Recursion AMP 2020; UC Santa Cruz	
Reading Group Talks		
2026	Syntax Workshop ; University of Massachusetts, Amherst Syntax Reading Group ; University of Maryland, College Park Syntax Reading Group ; Yale University	
2023	Smircle ; Stanford University Syntax Reading Group ; Yale University	
2022	Syntax Brown Bag ; NYU	
2021	Syntax and Semantics Circle ; UC Berkeley	
2020	Fieldwork Lab ; McGill University	
2019	Syntax Reading Group ; National University of Singapore	
Teaching at UCSC		
	Ling 112: Syntax 1. Teaching assistant.	
Fall 2024	Instructor: Roumyana Pancheva	
Fall 2020	Instructor: Jorge Hankamer	
	Ling 50: Intro to Linguistics. Teaching assistant.	
Spring 2025	Instructor: Grant McGuire	
Winter 2025	Instructor: Andrew Angeles	
Spring 2024	Ling 80K: Invented Languages. Teaching assistant. Instructor: Andrew Angeles	
Fall 2021	Ling 53: Semantics 1. Teaching assistant. Instructor: Maziar Toosarvandani	
Service		
AMERICA	Reviewer , Natural Language & Linguistic Theory	2024, 2025, 2026
	Reviewer , Oceanic Linguistics	2021

INDONESIA

Praat Workshops

Bina Nusantara University	April 2, 2024
The National Research and Innovation Agency	August 19, 2023
The Language Office of South Sulawesi	August 28, 2022

Undergraduate Syntax. Guest Lecturer.

Department of English, Bina Nusantara University	
Main Instructors: Clara Herlina Karjo, Menik Winiharti	June 5, 2023

Generative Grammar. Guest Lecturer.

Department of Linguistics, The Catholic University of Indonesia Atma Jaya	
Main Instructor: Yassir Tjung	Winter 2019

Advising

External Ph.D Thesis Committee Member

Siti Mafulah	
“Exploring student engagement with corrective feedback in EFL classrooms.”	
State University of Malang, Faculty of Literature	Fall 2022

External Undergraduate Thesis Committee Member

Jupri Talib	
“An Analysis of Rhyme and Rhythm in the Mandar Poetry of West Sulawesi”	
Kanjuruhan University of Malang, Faculty of Letters	Summer 2022

Coordinated Reading Groups

Syntax Lab

University of Pennsylvania	2025 – Present
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The Morphology Reading Group (MRG)

UC Santa Cruz	2020 – 2023
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The Syntax-Prosody Reading Group

Zoom: UCSC; McGill; MIT; NUS; Lund	2020 – 2021
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Labeling Out of Control

Zoom: UCSC; NYU; University of Chicago	2020 – 2021
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Undergraduate Syntax Club

UC Santa Cruz	2020 – 2023
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Languages

Native: English

Professional: Indonesian

Conversational: Javanese, Mandar, French

Other: $\LaTeX$, Praat, FLEx, Python, German, Spanish, Greek (Ancient/Medieval)